Student Level 120

Reading Comprehension Intervention Passages

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Anna

Anna loved to swim. She was a very good swimmer. Anna could do almost anything in the pool. She could swim forward and backward and float. She could jump and dive into the deep water from the side of the pool. The one thing Anna couldn't do was dive from the diving board. She was too scared.

Anna knew exactly why she was scared of the diving board. She had tried once to dive from the diving board. She climbed the short ladder to the end of the board. That part wasn't scary. But as Anna walked toward the other end, she felt the board bounce. Anna wasn't sure she liked that feeling. The closer Anna got to the other end of the diving board, the more it bounced. Anna was afraid to go any further. She turned around and walked carefully back to the ladder and climbed down. Anna was embarrassed that day and didn't want to try again.

About a year later, Anna was at the pool with her friends. They swam and splashed and played games in the water. Soon some of Anna's friends got bored and wanted to go diving. Anna didn't know what to do. She wanted to be with her friends but she was still scared of the diving board. Her friends said they would help her.

One friend climbed up the ladder with Anna. They walked slowly and carefully to the other end of the board. Anna's friend said they should jump together. They counted to three and then jumped. Anna couldn't believe how fun it was! Anna jumped many times after that. Each time she was less scared. Soon she began diving. Anna was very proud of herself.

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Questions for Anna

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What was Anna good at doing in the pool?

2. What was the one thing Anna was scared of doing?

3. What was it about the diving board that scared Anna?

4. Why was Anna embarrassed when she left the diving board the first time?

5. Why did Anna give up and not want to try again?

6. How much later is it in the story when Anna and her friends are at the pool?

7. How did Anna feel when her friends wanted to go to the diving board?

8. How did Anna's friends help her?

9. Why did Anna's friend suggest they jump at first instead of dive?

10. Why was Anna able to go off the diving board this time?

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Ben and Ava

Ben and Ava were brother and sister. Ben was older than Ava by one year. They loved to play together. When Ben was old enough, he joined a soccer team. Ben loved soccer. He liked playing goalie most of all. Ben asked his coach how he could become a better goalie. The coach told Ben that he should practice more.

Ben asked Ava if she would help him practice after school. Ben asked Ava to kick the soccer ball as hard and fast as she could toward the goal. Ben stood in front of the goal and waited for Ava to kick the ball. He was ready.

Ava looked carefully at the goal. She knew what Ben wanted her to do and she wanted to help her brother. When she finally kicked the ball, it went far away from the goal. Ben ran and got the ball and brought it back to Ava. She thought carefully about how to kick the ball just right. The ball missed the goal again. Ava felt bad that she wasn't helping Ben.

Then Ben had an idea. He showed Ava how to kick the ball. They spent some time kicking the ball back and forth. Ava learned how to make the ball go where she wanted it to go. Soon Ava was kicking the ball just where Ben wanted it to go. Ben got much better at being goalie. Ava got much better at kicking the ball. Soon she joined a soccer team too.

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Questions for Ben and Ava

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. Ben and Ava were brother and sister. Who was older?

2. Ben's favorite sport to play was soccer. What position did Ben like to play?

3. How can you tell that Ben liked to play goalie?

4. What did Ben's coach tell him to do to become a better goalie?

5. Why do you think Ben asked Ava to help him practice?

6. What happened when Ava first tried to help Ben?

7. Why did Ava feel bad when she kept missing the goal?

8. What did Ben do to help Ava get better at kicking?

9. How do you think that Ben and Ava feel about each other?

10. What did both Ben and Ava learn in this story?

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Cassie

Cassie wanted to catch a fish. She lived near a lake but had never been fishing. Cassie saw others catch fish and wanted to do the same. It looked like fun.

Cassie's family had a boat that they used on the lake. She asked her Mom to take her fishing in their boat. But Cassie's Mom said that she had to go to work. Next Cassie asked her Dad to take her fishing. Her Dad said their boat had a leak. It couldn't go out on the water.

Cassie didn't think she would ever get to catch a fish. One day she went to visit her Grandfather. He lived near Cassie. Cassie told him that she really wanted to go fishing. Her Grandfather told her to come back the next day.

Cassie went back the next day. Her Grandfather had a surprise for her. He showed her a small boat. Cassie and her Grandfather put on their life vests. They got some fishing poles and dug up some worms. Cassie's Grandfather rowed the boat to the middle of the lake. They put the worms on the hooks and put the hooks in the water.

Very soon, Cassie felt a tug on her pole. She pulled up the hook and found a big, fat fish on it. She had caught her first fish. Cassie's Grandfather showed her how to carefully take the hook from the fish. Then Cassie threw the fish back in the lake and they watched it swim away. Cassie couldn't wait to try catching another fish.

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Questions for Cassie

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Cassie want to do?

2. Why did Cassie want to catch a fish?

3. Where did Cassie live?

4. Why couldn't Cassie's mom take her fishing?

5. Cassie's dad wouldn't take her either because their boat had a leak. Why is it bad to have a leak?

6. Who else did Cassie ask to take her fishing?

7. Why did Cassie's Grandfather ask her to come back the next day?

8. Why did Cassie's and her Grandfather put life vests on?

9. What things did Cassie and her Grandfather take with them in the boat?

10. Why did Cassie throw the fish she caught back into the lake?

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Curtis

Curtis wanted to ride a skateboard. Most of his friends had skateboards and rode them in the park. Curtis wanted to ride with them. Sometimes he felt left out.

Curtis asked his parents to get him a skateboard. His mother and father said they would not get him a skateboard. They were afraid that he would fall and hurt himself. They did not want Curtis to get hurt. Curtis was sad. He really wanted to join his friends in the park.

Curtis had an idea. He would learn to ride a skateboard without getting hurt. First he had to get a skateboard to practice with. He asked his friend Donny to teach him to use a skateboard. Donny was a good skateboarder. He was happy to help.

First Donny showed Curtis how to wear his helmet and knee pads. Next Donny showed Curtis how to stand on the skateboard without falling. Then Donny gave him a small push. Curtis fell right away. He wasn't hurt and Curtis and Donny laughed. Curtis saw that learning to ride a skateboard was going to take hard work.

Curtis and Donny met after school to practice. At last Curtis was ready to show his parents that he could ride without getting hurt. His parents were proud to see how good Curtis was on the skateboard. For his birthday the next week, they gave Curtis a new skateboard, helmet and knee pads. Next time his friends went to the park, Curtis was with them.

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Questions for Curtis

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Curtis want to ride?

2. How did Curtis feel about not having a skateboard?

3. Why did Curtis' parents say they wouldn't get him a skateboard?

4. Were Curtis' parents good parents?

5. Curtis decided to learn to ride a skateboard to show his parents that he would be okay. Who does he ask for help?

6. Why do you think Curtis asked Donny to help instead of a different friend?

7. What happened the first time Donny and Curtis practiced?

8. How did Curtis know it was going to take hard work to learn to ride a skateboard?

9. Curtis' parents gave Curtis a skateboard for his birthday. Why did they change their minds?

10. How did Curtis feel the next time his friends went to the park?

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Sue

Sue had too many toys. That's what her mother said. Sue's mother was tired of finding them everywhere. She said Sue would have to get rid of some of the toys. Sue felt bad but knew that her mother was right. She didn't like picking them up all the time either.

One Saturday, Sue put all her toys in her room and looked at them carefully. She wondered which toys to get rid of. Sue decided to make different piles. One pile was for toys she didn't play with anymore. A second pile was for toys that were broken. A third pile was for toys she wanted to keep.

It took all day for Sue to sort the toys into one of the piles. Sometimes she couldn't decide what pile to put a toy into. Other times she put a toy in one pile but then changed her mind. Then she put it in another pile. Sue's mom checked on her and told Sue she was doing a great job.

Finally, Sue was finished. Her mom came in with a big trash bag. All the broken toys went into the trash. Then they picked up the toys Sue wanted to keep. They all fit into Sue's toy box. Sue wondered what to do with the toys that were left. They were good toys. She had liked them once but now she was too old for them. Then she remembered a daycare down the street. Sue talked to the owner who was glad to take the toys. Everyone was happy.

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Questions for Sue

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Sue have too many of?

2. Why was it time to get rid of some toys?

3. How did Sue decide which toys to get rid of?

4. Was it difficult for Sue to decide which toys to put in which pile?

5. Why did Sue's mom come to check on her?

6. When Sue finally finished sorting the toys, what did she and her mom do?

7. Was there anything wrong with the toys that Sue wanted to give away?

8. Who did Sue give the toys to?

9. Was Sue unhappy about giving the toys away?

10. Why was everyone happy at the end of the story?

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Cam

Cam had a problem. He couldn't tie his shoes. He always had to wait for someone to help him. This slowed him down and he was usually the last one in line. He wanted to learn how to do it himself. Cam needed to find someone to teach him.

He asked his friend Pete if he would teach him. Pete agreed to help him after school. They met outside the school and sat in the grass, facing each other. Pete tied his shoe while Cam watched. Then Cam tried. But he kept messing up. The laces were not staying in the right place. Cam sighed and put his head down. Pete knew he had to try something different.

Then Pete got an idea. He asked Cam to sit next to him. Then they each tied their shoe at the same time. They did it slowly. Pete waited to make sure Cam had it right before moving on to the next step. This worked much better. After doing this together over and over, Cam tried it on his own. It worked. Cam could tie his own shoes.

The next morning, Cam was happy he could get his shoes tied without waiting for help. He was proud to tell his teacher. She asked Cam if he could teach Eli, another student in class, how to tie his shoes. Cam smiled and nodded and went to find Eli.

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Questions for Cam

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Cam want to learn to do?

2. How did Cam think this would help his life?

3. When did Pete show Cam how to tie his shoes?

4. Why did Pete know to try a different way of teaching Cam?

5. How did Pete change the way he showed Cam?

6. Why did this way work better?

7. Who was Cam proud to tell at school?

8. Why did the teacher ask Cam to teach Eli?

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Casey

Casey loved being a superhero. His superhero clothes made him feel brave. He felt he could save the world. His mom liked having a superhero at home. She often asked Casey to use his powers to help her.

Casey always wore his superhero outfit when he did chores. His superhero outfit was perfect. His mom made it for him. His red cape had a big letter C on the back. It made him invisible. His black mask gave him super eyesight. His blue gloves made him strong like steel. He put it all on and was ready to help.

One of Casey's jobs at home was to take out the trash. It was heavy but Casey's gloves made the job easy. The garbage felt like a bag of feathers in his strong hands. Other times, he had to get stuff for his mom from the basement. There were eight-legged bad guys in the basement. When he wore his cape, they didn't even see him. He snuck right past their web traps.

Casey also helped find things for his mom. If there were socks or toys missing, Casey was on the job. He often found them under his bed. He wouldn't have seen them without his mask. Casey was happy to help his mom. His mom was happy to have a superhero to help with chores.

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Questions for Casey

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Casey love being?

2. Why did his mom ask him to use his powers to help her?

3. Who made Casey's superhero outfit?

4. What color was his cape?

5. Why did Casey think his costume gave him super powers?

6. What were Casey's jobs?

7. What were the 8-legged bad guys in the basement?

8. What did Casey find under his bed?

9. What was Casey's mom teaching him?

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Drake

Drake had a bad habit. He chewed his fingernails. Drake had been chewing his fingernails since he was very young. His mom did not want him to chew his nails. She was afraid it would make him sick. Drake had tried to stop but he just couldn't. He asked his mom to help him stop chewing his fingernails for good.

First they tried covering his fingernails with bandages. Drake thought that would work for sure. There was no way he could chew his nails when they were covered up. He wore the bandages to school that day. Everyone asked him what happened to his fingers. They thought he had been hurt. Drake told them what the bandages were for. The kids teased him so Drake took the bandages off. Before long he was chewing his fingernails again.

Drake's mom had another idea. She brought home a bottle that looked like clear fingernail polish. It was not polish. She brushed some on one of Drake's fingernails. Then she told him to chew it. As soon as Drake put the finger in his mouth, he yanked it away. He made a terrible face. Drake and his mom thought they had found the answer.

The next morning, Drake's mom covered all his fingernails with the clear stuff. Drake knew he wouldn't chew his fingernails that day. Even after Drake washed his hands, the bad taste was still there. For one week Drake covered his fingernails. Then he didn't need the stuff anymore. He had finally ended his bad habit. They best part was that no one teased him.

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Questions for Drake

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What was Drake's bad habit?

2. Why couldn't Drake stop chewing his nails?

3. What was his mom's first idea for helping Drake?

4. Why didn't that work?

5. What did Drake's mom try next?

6. Why did Drake yank his finger away from his mouth and make a terrible face?

7. What happened when Drake washed his hands?

8. How long did Drake have to cover his nails with the bad tasting stuff?

9. Why did it work?

10. Why didn't anyone tease him this time?

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Phillip

Phillip wanted to play with his brother Tom's new race car. He knew he was supposed to ask before using it, but his brother wasn't home. So Phillip decided he would play with it, but be very careful. He planned to put it back right where he found it. His brother would never know.

Phillip got the car down from the shelf. It was red and shiny and could go really fast. He turned it on. He ran it up and down the hall. He built tunnels out of boxes for it to go through. He ran it under the bed. Before he knew it, he heard his brother come home. Phillip quickly turned the car off and put it away.

Phillip's brother Tom came in to his room and got his car. Phillip felt uneasy. Luckily he didn't break it, so nothing bad happened. Tom turned the car on but the car went very slow and then stopped. Tom said that the batteries were dead. He had just put in new ones and he didn't have any more. Tom was upset.

Phillip felt very bad. He told Tom that he had played with the car without asking and must have used up the batteries. He said he was sorry. Tom said that was okay, but he was still sad. Phillip said he would buy him some new batteries. He got his wallet and asked if Tom would walk with him to the hardware store. Phillip knew he wouldn't use something that wasn't his without asking again.

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Questions for Phillip

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Phillip want to play with?

2. Why did Phillip decide to go ahead and not wait to ask?

3. Where did Phillip play with the car?

4. Why did Phillip put the car away?

5. Why was Phillip surprised to hear his brother come home?

6. Why did Phillip feel uneasy when his brother came in to play with the car?

7. What happened when Tom turned the car on?

8. Even though Phillip was careful and didn't break the car, how did he cause a problem with it?

9. What did Phillip do to try to make up for the used batteries?

10. Why did Phillip ask Tom to come with him to the store?

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Kate

Kate's mom was having a new baby. Kate was excited to have a new brother or sister. No one knew if the baby would be a boy or a girl. Kate couldn't wait to find out.

One morning Kate woke up to find her grandmother making breakfast instead of her mom and dad. Kate knew what that meant! Grandmother said they would be home later that day with the baby. Kate asked her grandmother if it was a boy or a girl. Kate's grandmother said it was still a surprise. Kate would have to wait until she met the baby to find out. Kate was both disappointed and excited.

Kate's grandmother suggested that they do some chores to keep themselves busy. Kate dusted every room. She helped her grandmother wash the dishes. Together they cleaned the kitchen and made the beds. They picked flowers from the garden and put them in a vase. When the house looked good, Kate and her grandmother started cooking. Grandmother said that Kate's mom would be too tired to cook. They made enough food so that Kate's mom wouldn't have to cook for some time.

While they worked, Kate thought about the new baby. Would it be a brother? Or a sister? What was the baby's name? Kate wondered if she would be a good big sister. Kate was tired from all the working and thinking. She went to her room to lie down for just a minute.

When Kate's parents came home that night, Kate was sound asleep. They didn't want to wake her up. Kate would have to wait one more day to meet her new sister.

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Questions for Kate

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What is Kate excited about?

2. What did it mean to Kate when she woke up and saw her grandmother making breakfast instead of her parents?

3. Did Kate's grandmother tell Kate if the baby was a boy or girl?

4. Why was Kate both disappointed and excited when her grandmother wouldn't tell her?

5. Why did Kate's grandmother suggest they keep busy?

6. What are some of the chores that Kate and her grandmother did?

7. Why did Kate and her grandmother do so much cooking?

8. Why was Kate so tired when they were finished?

9. Why did Kate want to lie down for just a minute?

10. When did Kate finally get to meet her new sister?

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Kim

Kim wanted to be just like her older sister, Lin. She tried to do everything the same as Lin. She wore her hair the same. She tried to dress like her. She hung out with Lin's friends when they were over. She even picked the same favorite color. This was driving Lin crazy.

Lin did not want her little sister doing everything she did. She thought Kim was just trying to bug her. Lin asked her mom what to do. Her mom explained that it was a good thing. She said it showed how much Kim loved her and admired her. She said the role of a big sister is very important. Her mom told her that when she was a little girl, she wanted to be just like her older sister, too. And they grew up to be very close friends.

That made Lin stop and think. The next day Lin braided her hair. Then she offered to help braid Kim's hair. Kim asked to borrow a shirt. Lin said that it was okay. Lin's friends said they liked playing with Kim. They said she was lucky to have a sister to play with. Lin and Kim did have a lot of fun playing games together at home. Now she didn't mind that, either.

Pretty soon Lin didn't even think about it anymore. Her mom asked her how it was going. She said it was going much better. She said that Kim was a pretty good little sister. Her mom told her that she thought Kim was lucky to have such was a good big sister. Lin knew that she and Kim would always be good friends.

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Questions for Kim

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What was bothering Lin?

2. Who did Lin ask what to do?

3. Why did her mom tell her about her own sister?

4. What did Lin offer to do for Kim?

5. What did Lin say Kim could borrow?

6. Why did what her friends said make her see her sister differently?

7. What did Lin tell her mom about how it was going?

8. Why did Lin think she and Kim would always be good friends?

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Tanya

Tanya liked the rain. She liked it mostly because she liked to jump and splash in puddles. The only problem was that her shoes, socks and pants got very wet. When she came inside, she made a big mess with all her wet clothes.

One day, her mom gave her a bag of hand-me-down clothes from her cousin. Tanya loved getting hand-me-downs from her cousin. She pulled out shirts and pants. When she got to the bottom of the bag, she gasped. There was a pair of red rain boots. Her mom looked excited, too. Tanya tried them on. Tanya walked around in them. The boots were a little bit big, but her mom said that they should be fine.

Now Tanya could play in puddles and not get her shoes all wet. She put the boots by the back door and looked outside. There were some grey clouds in the sky. Maybe it would rain soon. When Tanya woke up the next day, she listened. She heard rain on the roof. She jumped out of bed and ran to the back door. She popped on her rain boots. Then she bolted outside. She splashed and jumped in the puddles.

When she came back inside, she was so happy. She loved her rain boots. She told her mom how dry her feet were. Her mom looked at her wet clothes and smiled. Then her mom hung Tanya's raincoat next to the rain boots. That way Tanya might wear it next time, too.

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Questions for Tanya

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Tanya like to do in the rain?

2. Why was it a problem for her that she got so wet?

3. What did Tanya's mom have for her in a bag?

4. Why did Tanya's mom think the boots were fine if they were a little big?

5. Where did Tanya put her boots?

6. What did Tanya do in the morning that showed she was excited that it rained?

7. What kept Tanya's feet dry?

8. What did Tanya's mom smile think when Tanya came back inside and said her feet were dry?

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Lulu

Lulu lived near the ocean. The sound of the waves at night helped her fall asleep. Lulu and her grandfather walked on the beach every day. They often found interesting things on their walks.

One time Lulu and her grandfather found a piece of wood on the beach. The wood had writing on it. Lulu couldn't read it. Her grandfather said it looked like part of a box from another country. He pointed to a picture on the wood. It was an orange. Lulu and her grandfather talked about how the box got to their beach. Lulu had dreams that night about living in another country.

Another time Lulu and her grandfather found a starfish. They were excited because Lulu had never seen one except at the zoo. Lulu couldn't believe that she was looking at a real one. She and her grandfather watched it for a short while. Then Lulu carefully picked it up and took it back to the water. They watched it swim away. They smiled at each other. They had done a good thing.

The best thing Lulu and her grandfather ever found was a bottle. Usually the bottles they found were just trash. They picked those up and threw them away. This bottle was special. It had a piece of paper inside. Lulu and her grandfather carefully opened the bottle and took out the paper. It was a note! The note was from a girl named Jody. The note said Jody hoped someone would find the bottle and write to her. Lulu and her grandfather looked at each other. They smiled and hurried home.

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Questions for Lulu

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. Who did Lulu walk with every day?

2. Why did the waves help Lulu get to sleep?

3. A picture of what fruit was on the piece of wood they found?

4. Why did Lulu dream that night about living in another country?

5. What kind of fish did they find one day?

6. Why was it a good thing that Lulu put the starfish back in the water?

7. What was the best thing that Lulu and her grandfather found on the beach?

8. Why did they think this was the best thing they had found?

9. Who wrote the note inside the bottle?

10. Why did Lulu and her grandfather smile at each other and hurry home?

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Mark

Mark and his class were going to the zoo. Mark was excited to see the lions. You could say that lions were Mark's favorite animal. He read books about lions. He watched movies about lions. He even had a stuffed lion he called Leo. He couldn't wait to see the real lions at the zoo.

The first thing Mark did when he got to the zoo was go to see the lions. The lions lived in a large grassy field behind a tall fence. Mark looked and looked but he couldn't see any lions. There were trees, bushes and huge rocks. Maybe the lions were hiding. He walked around the whole area but couldn't see lions anywhere. Mark was worried.

Then Mark saw a sign he had missed before. The sign said that the lions were with the dentist. They were getting their teeth cleaned. Mark was disappointed but he also laughed.

Mark went to join the rest of his class. On the way, he saw a golden flash. He ran quickly to another large, grassy area behind a different fence. It took him a minute to see the gold flash was an animal. Mark had never seen an animal run so fast. When it slowed down, Mark could see it was a cheetah. He read everything the sign said about cheetahs. Soon Mark had a new favorite animal.

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Questions for Mark

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What was Mark's favorite animal at the beginning of the story?

2. How can you tell that Marks favorite animals were lions?

3. Where did the lions live at the zoo?

4. Why was Mark worried when he didn't see the lions?

5. Where were the lions?

6. Why did Mark laugh even though he was disappointed?

7. What caught Mark's eye as he left the lion area?

8. Why did Mark run to find out what the golden flash was?

9. What was the animal Mark saw?

10. Why did Mark decide to make cheetahs his new favorite animal?

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Mia

Mia had long brown hair. Lots of people told Mia how pretty her long hair was. But Mia did not like it. Every morning before school, Mia's mother brushed her long hair. She wanted Mia to look neat. But every morning, Mia would cry because her hair was tangled. It hurt when her mother brushed out the tangles. Mia wished there was a way to stop her hair from getting so tangled.

Mia asked her friend Sally what to do. Sally had long hair too but it was curly and not as long as Mia's. Sally told Mia that she put her hair in braids at night before bed. Sally said that in the morning, her hair wasn't tangled. Mia asked her mom to put her hair in braids that night. She went to bed happy. She knew she wouldn't have tangles in the morning.

During the night, Mia's braids came undone. Mia's hair was too slippery to keep the braids. In the morning, her hair was just as tangled as always. Mia cried and wished she could cut off all her hair. Mia's mom felt bad and wanted to do something to help Mia.

Mia's mother picked her up after school. She asked Mia if she still wanted to cut all her hair off. Her mother told her that short hair didn't get tangled. She asked Mia if she wanted a haircut. Mia said yes.

The next morning, Mia had a big smile. Her hair had not been tangled at all. It did not hurt to brush it. When she got to school, all her friends told her how pretty her new short hair was.

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Questions for Mia

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Mia's hair look like?

2. Why did Mia cry when her mother brushed her hair?

3. Why did Mia ask her friend Sally for help?

4. What did Sally do to keep her hair from being tangled?

5. Why did braids keep Sally from having tangled hair in the mornings?

6. What happened when Mia tried putting her hair in braids at night?

7. Why do you think that braids worked for Sally but not for Mia?

8. Why would Mia's mom feel bad about brushing her hair?

9. What did Mia's mom suggest as a way to avoid tangles?

10. Do you think Mia was happy with her haircut? Why?

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Mo

Mo had a dog named Pal. Pal loved to run in the field by their house. They played fetch. Mo threw sticks as far as he could. Pal raced to get them. Then he brought them back to Mo.

One day, Mo threw a stick for Pal to fetch. It landed behind a tree. Pal ran after the stick but didn't come back right away. When Mo called, Pal ran back but there was a terrible smell. Mo didn't know where it was coming from. They ran home. As soon as they were on the back step, Mo's dad said that he smelled a skunk.

Then Mo knew what had happened. Pal must have scared a skunk by the tree and got sprayed. Mo's dad said they better keep Pal outside and give him a bath right away. Mo got the kiddie pool and filled it with water. Mo's dad mixed a special shampoo to get the skunk smell off. Pal liked the bath. After scrubbing him, they rinsed him off with the hose. Then they dried him with a towel.

Mo and his dad sniffed Pal. They both agreed that it worked. The skunk smell was gone. Mo could let Pal go in the house again. Mo knew he would not throw sticks for Pal to fetch over by that tree again. And, now he knew how bad a skunk's spray smells.

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Questions for Mo

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. Where did Mo and Pal play fetch?

2. What did Mo throw for Pal?

3. How did Mo's dad know it was a skunk that he smelled?

4. Why didn't Mo's dad want Pal to come in the house?

5. What did they give Pal a bath in?

6. What did they use to dry Pal off?

7. How did they know the shampoo worked?

8. Why did Mo decide he wouldn't throw stick by the tree for Pal to fetch?

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Robbie

Robbie wished he had a brother. His neighbor Luke had a big brother. Luke and his big brother did fun stuff together all the time. Robbie watched them through his window. Sometimes Robbie had to walk away from the window.

Robbie's mom and dad were going out for dinner and got a babysitter. Robbie asked who the babysitter was. His mom told him it was a surprise. She said that Robbie would be happy with the babysitter. Robbie couldn't wait to find out who it was.

The night finally arrived for the babysitter to come. All week Robbie had begged his mom to tell him who it was. She told him it was a fun surprise and he had to wait. When the doorbell rang, Robbie was the first one there. He opened the door and guess who he saw? It was Luke's big brother! And standing right behind him was Luke! Both brothers had come. Robbie's mom told Robbie that Luke's brother was the babysitter. She said that Luke really wanted to come too.

The three boys played well together. Luke's brother played with Robbie just like a big brother. They even played some of the games Robbie had watched from his window. When Robbie's parents got home, he told them what fun he'd had. Robbie's parents were happy to see the house looking neat. They said that Luke's brother could babysit anytime. Robbie's smile took up his whole face.

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Questions for Robbie

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Robbie wish he had?

2. Why did Robbie sometimes walk away from the window when he watched Luke and his brother play?

3. Why did Robbie need a babysitter?

4. Why didn't Robbie's mom tell him who the babysitter was?

5. When Robbie opened the door, he saw two people. Who?

6. Why do you think that Luke wanted to come too?

7. How did Luke's big brother treat Robbie?

8. What kinds of games did they play?

9. Why were Robbie's parents happy to have Luke's brother babysit again?

10. Why was Robbie's smile so big?

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Robert

Robert was bored with lunch. Every day he got the same thing. He got a cheese sandwich, an apple and some chips. He liked that lunch but he didn't want it every day. Robert wanted to try some new foods for lunch.

Robert asked his mother if he could try different foods for lunch. She was happy to help but said lunch had to be easy and fast to make. Robert had two brothers and one sister. Robert's mom had a lot of lunches to make every day.

She asked Robert if he would like a peanut butter and jelly sandwich. Robert loved peanut butter and jelly but one of his friends was allergic to peanut butter. That wouldn't work. Next Robert's mother asked if he would like soup for lunch. Robert said that sounded good. He loved soup. The next day Robert's mother put some chicken noodle soup in his lunch. But when it was time for lunch, the soup was cold. Robert did not like cold soup.

One day Robert told his friends how bored he was with his lunch. His friend Paul got school lunch. Paul said that school lunch was different every day. Robert looked at Paul's lunches for a few days. They all looked good. Sometimes there was even soup.

Robert asked his mother if he could get school lunch. She thought it sounded like a great idea. She signed him, his brothers and sister up right away. Robert couldn't wait for lunch every day. He wasn't bored any more.

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Questions for Robert

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Robert get for lunch every day?

2. What was wrong with that lunch?

3. Robert asks his mom if he can have different foods sometimes. She says that lunch has to be fast and easy to make. Why does she say that?

4. Robert's mom says she can make him peanut butter and jelly sandwiches. Why is that not a good idea?

5. Robert's mom asks if he would like soup in his lunch. What kinds of soup does she give him?

6. Unfortunately the soup gets cold before Robert could eat it and he doesn't like it. Why do you think Robert didn't like the cold soup?

7. Which of Robert's friends tells him about school lunch?

8. Do you think Paul likes school lunch? Why?

9. Why was Robert happy to get school lunch?

10. Why did Robert's mom think getting school lunch was a good idea?

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Rocky

Rocky loved to climb. He climbed everything he could. When Rocky was little he climbed out of his crib. He climbed out of his high chair. He even climbed into the kitchen sink. As Rocky got older, he climbed small trees then bigger trees. When he went to school, Rocky was the fastest climber on the playground. But he was bored. He never got to climb anything new.

One day Rocky got into trouble. His teacher found him trying to climb the bookshelf in her classroom. Rocky's teacher told him that climbing the bookshelf was dangerous. She said it could fall over on him. She told Rocky's parents that Rocky could not climb anything inside the school. Rocky could only climb outside and that was boring.

Rocky's friend Toby liked to climb things too. Toby also got into trouble with the teacher. He had tried to climb the bookshelf in her room too. Rocky and Toby wished they could find a new climbing place.

That weekend, Rocky's parents said they had a surprise for him and Toby. They drove the boys to huge building. It didn't have any windows. When Rocky and Toby walked in, they saw very high walls. The walls had bright colored rocks sticking out. People were climbing on the rocks. Some were all the way to the top of the walls. They wore belts and ropes to keep them safe. Rocky and Toby couldn't wait to try it. They put on the safety ropes and began to climb. They were surprised at how hard it was. They did not make it to the top that day. The boys made plans to come back another time. Rocky and Toby and finally had a new place to climb.

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Questions for Rocky

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Rocky love to do?

2. How can you tell that Rocky loves to climb?

3. Why did Rocky get into trouble with his teacher?

4. Why do you think the teacher was upset with Rocky?

5. What was the name of Rocky's friend who also liked to climb?

6. Why do you think Rocky and Toby were good friends?

7. Rocky's parents took the boys to a special place. What did they see when they got there?

8. How do you think the boys felt when they saw the building?

9. What kind of equipment was everyone wearing to keep them safe?

10. Why did Rocky and Toby make plans to go back again?

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Roger

Roger loved to watch the rabbits in his backyard. They looked soft and cuddly. He liked to watch them hop and play. Roger laughed out loud when they chased each other. Even the way they chewed their food was cute.

Roger's mom did not think the rabbits were so cute. They ate many of the plants in her garden. Roger's mom worked hard in their yard. She didn't want her work to be wasted. Roger and his mom decided to work together to solve the rabbit problem.

Roger's mom got some small white balls. They had a very strong smell. The smell would keep the rabbits away from the plants. Roger and his mom soon realized that they smelled too strong. They didn't even want to be in the yard. The balls were not a good idea. Next Roger's mom suggested that Roger squirt water at the rabbits when they were in the garden. Roger tried it but the rabbits just chased the water. Roger laughed but his mom did not.

One day Roger's mom brought home some wire. She told Roger they were going to build a fence. All day they worked to put the wire around the garden. When they finished, they had a wire fence that would keep the rabbits away from the plants. Roger and his mom got some lemonade and watched the rabbits. The rabbits were busy hopping from spot to spot eating the grass in the yard. Both Roger and his mom laughed.

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Questions for Roger

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What animal did Roger watch in his backyard?

2. Why did Roger like to watch them?

3. Why was Roger's mom unhappy about having the rabbits in their yard?

4. Why did she think her work was wasted?

5. Why did Roger and his mom decide to work together on the rabbit problem?

6. Why didn't the small white balls work?

7. What did Roger try next?

8. Why did Roger laugh but his mom didn't when he tried to squirt them?

9. What did Roger and his mom finally do to keep the rabbits out?

10. Why did Roger's mom finally laugh at the end of the story?

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Rosa

Rosa rode the school bus every day. She loved to look out the windows. Every day the bus went past a park with a small lake. Rosa saw people walking and jogging around the lake. Some people pushed strollers. Other people were on roller skates or bikes. Rosa liked seeing the happy people.

One morning Rosa saw lots of geese on the lake. Rosa thought they looked like a happy family. She watched them splash and swim. She saw them duck their heads underwater for food. Rosa was happy to have something new to look at.

On the bus ride home, Rosa was excited to see the geese again. This time she saw one little goose by itself. It did not splash and swim like the others. Rosa wondered if it was hurt. Rosa asked the driver if he had seen the hurt goose. He said that he had been too busy driving. Rosa thought the little goose needed help.

At home, Rosa told her mother about the hurt goose. Rosa and her mom walked back to the park. They could see many geese in the water. Rosa couldn't see the little goose at first. Then she saw it swimming behind a bigger goose. It looked happy. Rosa and her mom watched for a while as the little goose swam, splashed and looked for food. It was hard to leave but Rosa looked forward to her bus ride in the morning.

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Questions for Rosa

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. How did Rosa get to school each day?

2. How could Rosa know the people she could see from the bus were happy?

3. What does Rosa see one morning on the lake?

4. What are the geese doing?

5. Why does Rosa think they look like a happy family?

6. On the way home that day, Rosa sees a goose she thinks might be hurt. Why does she think it might be hurt?

7. Why didn't the bus driver notice the hurt goose?

8. When Rosa tells her mother about the hurt goose, she taker her back to the park. Why?

9. How do Rosa and her mother know the little goose is okay?

10. Why did Rosa look forward to her bus ride in the morning?

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Tim

Tim did not like to brush his teeth. He sometimes skipped it. His parents seemed to know this and asked him to go back in and brush. He just didn't want to. He didn't understand why it was so important. Then they had a dentist visit their school. The dentist showed them how important it was for them to take care of their teeth.

The dentist said they should brush two times each day. She also said they should brush for two or three minutes. The dentist said to use a timer to be sure they do it long enough. She set the timer and showed them how to brush correctly.

Tim saw pictures of the way people used to brush long ago. They didn't have toothpaste so they used chalk or charcoal. And their teeth did not look very good. She also showed what sugar does to teeth. It causes cavities. She said that is why sugary drinks are so bad for your teeth. Tim wanted his teeth to last. He did not want cavities.

That night for a snack, Tim asked for water instead of soda. Then Tim asked his mom for a timer. He set the timer and brushed for three minutes. It was a lot longer than he had been doing it before. Now he knew what he should do to make his teeth healthy his whole life.

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Questions for Tim

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What didn't Tim like to do?

2. How did Tim's parents always know when he didn't brush long enough?

3. Why did Tim listen to the dentist and not his parents about brushing?

4. Why did it help for the dentist to set the timer and show them how long to brush?

5. What does sugar do to teeth?

6. How many times a day are people supposed to brush their teeth?

7. How long should you brush?

8. Why do you think Tim will keep his teeth healthy?

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Ben

Ben's dad took him to the barber shop. Ben did not like to get his hair cut. He did not like the sound of the clippers. He did not like wearing a cape. He did not like it when they used a spray bottle to get his hair wet. And, he did not like all the little hairs on his neck.

Ben told his dad that he did not need a haircut. His dad said Ben's hair was too long. He said he wanted Ben to look his best for school pictures. Ben told him why he did not like getting his haircut. His dad said that they should talk to the barber.

When it was Ben's turn, they asked if he could use a scissors and not a clipper. The barber said that was no problem. They asked if he had to use a spray bottle. The barber said he could use a wet comb instead. Ben asked if he had to wear a cape. The barber said the cape keeps the hair off his back. Ben agreed it was better to wear the cape.

After the haircut, Ben felt good. He brushed all the hair off his neck. Then he gave his dad a high five. He was glad they had asked the barber to change some things. He still didn't love to get his haircut, but it was not so bad.

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Questions for Ben

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. Where did Ben's dad take him?

2. Why didn't Ben like getting his hair cut?

3. What tells you that Ben is sensitive?

4. Why did Ben's dad want him to get a haircut?

5. What did the barber say he could do to get Ben's hair wet?

6. Why did Ben decide to use the cape?

7. How could Ben's dad tell he felt good about the haircut?

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Eva

Eva always eats lunch with the same group of friends. They come in the lunchroom and sit down at the same table every day. They talk and laugh while they eat. When they are done, they all get up and run outside for recess.

One day Eva saw a girl sitting by herself in the lunchroom. Eva went over to meet her. The girl said her name was Jo. Eva asked Jo if she wanted to come over to sit at her table. Jo looked down and shook her head. Eva said that was okay. She went back to her table. She was not sure if Jo was shy or if she really wanted to be by herself.

The next day Eva saw Jo sitting by herself again. She decided to try something different. Eva asked if she could eat at Jo's table. Jo nodded yes. Eva ate with her. She got to know her. Now Eva knows that Jo did not want to be by herself. She thinks Jo felt too shy to join all the kids at her table at once. Soon, Eva's friends asked if they could join them, too.

Now they all eat together every day. And now Eva always looks around the lunchroom. If anyone is sitting alone she asks if she can join them. She knows it might take a few tries before they say yes. Eva wants to do her best to include everyone.

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Questions for Eva

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. Who did Eva sit with for lunch every day?

2. Do you think they are trying to exclude other kids?

3. Who did Eva meet who was sitting by herself?

4. Why was Jo eating by herself?

5. What did Eva try different the next day?

6. Why did that work better for Jo?

7. What did the other friends do?

8. What has Eva learned about including people?

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Ted

Ted was the tallest boy in his class. He really wished he were shorter. He was always last in line. He bumped his head on high shelves. His knees rubbed the desk in front of him. His shoes were very big. He had to go to a special shoe store to find his size. He was good in basketball, but really wanted to be better in gymnastics.

Ted and Cal were friends. Cal was the shortest boy is his class. Cal wished he were taller. He wanted to play basketball and couldn't reach as high as Cal. He had to stand on a stool to reach the top book shelf. He was good in gymnastics, but he really wanted to be better in basketball.

They talked about how they wish they could switch. Ted said that it would be great to be shorter. Cal said it would be great to be taller. Their teacher heard them talking. He said that each boy would grow at different rates. The difference in their heights will probably change. He said each boy should make the most of the height they are now.

Ted and Cal listened to their teacher. They didn't know how they would change as they grew. They decided to cheer for each other and be the best they could be. They also realized that they made an awesome pair. Together they had the advantages of both tall and short.

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Questions for Ted

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. Who was the tallest boy in class?

2. Why did Ted want to be shorter?

3. What sport was Ted good at?

4. Why did Ted want to be better at gymnastics?

5. Who was the shortest boy in class?

6. Why did Cal want to be taller?

7. What sport was Cal really good at?

8. What did the boys talk about doing?

9. How did the teacher get them to think differently about their heights?

10. Why did the boys think they made an awesome pair?

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